

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

How Names Can Tell Painful Stories

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 18

NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS - Names, identity and history

No.	Sentence
1	A name is closely connected to a person's feelings and _____.
2	Some people consider a change because their name recalls _____ in the past.
3	In Christianity, many names carry a _____.
4	The missionary after whom the bishop was named set up several _____ in South India.
5	Despite his good aims, his _____ with colonial rulers gives the name a difficult history.
6	Names in India can indicate a person's _____.
7	Conversion to Christianity and new names gave some families greater _____ from social discrimination.
8	The Beckford surname carries a family history of _____ in Jamaica.
9	The professor admires biblical figures who challenge _____.
10	For his own name, however, no biblical choice really _____ with him.

11 What contrast about personal names introduces the discussion?

- A They shape how people see themselves, although parents usually choose them.
- B They matter mainly in childhood, although adults continue to use them.
- C They reflect family history, although most people select them as adults.
- D They express religious beliefs, although families may later reject them.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

- 12 **How does the discussion broaden the reasons for changing a birth name?**
- A It shifts from cultural pronunciation to difficulties with legal records.
 - B It shifts from simple dislike to painful connections with past unfairness.
 - C It shifts from family pressure to a desire for religious recognition.
 - D It shifts from social standing to a preference for shorter names.
- 13 **What makes the missionary's legacy difficult for the bishop to carry?**
- A His schools were opened only after colonial rule ended.
 - B His religious aims prevented him from helping local children.
 - C His family name was adopted without the bishop's knowledge.
 - D His educational work was tied to support for colonial power.
- 14 **What can be inferred about discussing the British Empire's role in India?**
- A Family names provide a complete record of colonial events.
 - B The missionaries' schools settle the question of the empire's value.
 - C A fair assessment should consider both educational work and colonial harm.
 - D The empire's influence ended when people changed religion.
- 15 **How did taking Christian names help some low-status Indians?**
- A It made their original names easier for others to pronounce.
 - B It allowed them to claim a higher position within the empire.
 - C It offered a way to avoid discrimination linked to social status.
 - D It preserved the names used by earlier generations of their family.
- 16 **What broader point does the Beckford surname illustrate?**
- A A surname can reveal exactly where an ancestor was born.
 - B A surname can show whether a person shares an ancestor's beliefs.
 - C A surname can lose its historical meaning within one generation.
 - D A surname can carry a painful past into later generations.
- 17 **What quality in biblical figures influenced the name chosen for the professor's son?**
- A Their readiness to confront injustice and powerful people.
 - B Their success in gaining authority within government.
 - C Their ability to avoid upsetting people with different views.
 - D Their willingness to leave their inherited names behind.

18 **What might the final reflection imply for someone who keeps a name with a painful history?**

- A Its religious origin determines how others will judge the person.
- B The person may still give the name significance through their actions.
- C Its historical meaning should always lead to a change.
- D The person's family must decide how the name is used.